

Republic Act No. 1425

“ AN ACT TO INCLUDE IN THE CURRICULA OF ALL PUBLIC AND PRIVATE SCHOOLS, COLLEGES AND UNIVERSITIES COURSES ON THE LIFE, WORKS AND WRITINGS OF JOSE RIZAL, PARTICULARLY HIS NOVELS NOLI ME TANGERE AND EL FILIBUSTERISMO, AUTHORIZING THE PRINTING AND DISTRIBUTION THEREOF, AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES ”

- Rededication to the ideals of freedom and nationalism for which our heroes lived and died
- Honor them (Esp Rizal), remember their lives and work
- Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo are sources of patriotism which should be taught in formative years.
- All schools must teach to develop character, personal discipline, civic conscience and duties of citizenship.

Section 1:

Mandates that courses on José Rizal's life and works, including his novels *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*, be included in all Philippine school curricula. Colleges must use the original or unedited versions, or their English translations, as primary texts. The Board of National Education will implement this requirement, create necessary materials, and establish rules, including exemptions for religious beliefs, within 60 days. These rules take effect 30 days after publication in the Official Gazette.

Section 2:

All schools, colleges, and universities must keep an adequate number of copies of the original and unedited versions of *Noli Me Tangere*, *El Filibusterismo*, and other works and biographies of José Rizal in their libraries. These editions, or their English translations, must be on the approved reading list for all educational institutions. The Board of National Education will decide the appropriate number of copies based on student enrollment.

Section 3:

The Board of National Education shall cause the translation of the *Noli Me Tangere* and *El Filibusterismo*, as well as other writings of Jose Rizal into English, Tagalog and the principal Philippine dialects; cause them to be printed in cheap, popular editions; and cause them to be distributed, free of charge, to persons desiring to read them, through the Purok organizations and Barrio Councils throughout the country.

Section 4:

clarifies that this Act does not change or repeal Section 927 of the Administrative Code, which forbids public school teachers and staff from discussing religious doctrines.

Section 5:

A sum of **three hundred thousand pesos** is allocated from the National Treasury to implement this Act.

Section 6:

This Act shall take effect upon its approval.

Approved: June 12, 1956

The Trials of Rizal Bill

Republic Act No. 1425

“Rizal Law”

- Filed by the Committee on Education on April 3, 1956
- “Senate Bill No. 438 ” was supported by all except 3 members of the Upper House.

Original Version of Senate Bill No. 438:

“AN ACT TO MAKE NOLI ME TANGERE AND EL FILIBUSTERISMO COMPULSORY READING MATTER IN ALL PUBLIC AND PRIVATE COLLEGES AND UNIVERSITIES AND FOR OTHER PURPOSES.”

Section 1:

Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo are hereby declared compulsory reading matter in all public and private schools, colleges and universities in the Philippines.

Section 2:

Work mentioned in section 1 shall be in original editions or in unexpurgated version.

Section 3: (Sec. 2?)

Deped must make known of rules and regulations for the immediate implementation.

Section 4:

No provision is constructed as prohibiting or limiting the study of the work of other Filipino Heroes.

Section 5:

Public or private College/university found violating:

- a. The Head in charge of implementing the act and failing to comply shall be dismissed immediately and shall be disqualified from teaching in any public or government recognized private school, college and university.
- b. Government recognition of any private college or university is immediately withdrawn and the responsible head and professor or professors concerned is disqualified from teaching in any government recognized college or uni.

Senator Laurel: disseminate the ideals of the great Filipino Patriot through reading his works.

Three day sponsorship speech:

- Noli and El fili must be read by all Filipinos.
- Learn to prepare ourselves for painful sacrifices that ultimately lead to self-reliance, self-respect and freedom.
- Catholics were not in favor because they believe that his novels are heretical and impious.

Debates on Senate Bill No. 438 began on April 23, 1956:

- Senator Laurel was supported by Senator Claro M. Recto
- *Rabid Catholics:* Other camps were Senator Mariano J. Cuenco, Francisco Rodrigo and Decoroso Rosales.
- Senator Recto brilliance in history, law, canon Law and Life and & works of rizal
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